

A

Containers and contents*

a **bag of** shoppinga **bottle of** apple juicea **jar of** jama **bowl of** sugara **jug of** watera **box of** chocolatesa **packet of** biscuitsa **packet of** crispsa **can of** colaa **carton of** orange juicea **tube of** toothpastea **vase of** flowersa **tin of** fruita **bar of** chocolate

* the things inside something

Language help

A **tin** usually has something we eat inside it; a **can** has something we drink.

B

Quantities*

Just a **drop of** milk [a very small amount] and no sugar in my coffee, please.

I've cut three **slices of** beef; that should be enough for the sandwiches. (Or three **pieces of** beef)

I took my boss a **bunch of** flowers when I visited her in hospital.

I need a **sheet of** paper. (Or a **piece/bit of** paper)

Andrew bought two **pairs of** trousers and a pair of shoes yesterday.

I bought a **couple of** books. [two, perhaps three]

We saw **several** churches on our way here. [some but not a lot, e.g. between three and eight]

I bought **half a dozen** eggs at the supermarket. [six]

There are a **dozen** students in the class. [twelve]

Could I have a **spoonful of** sugar in my tea?

We've got **plenty of** time. [a lot of]

The company is now making the toys in **large quantities**.

* the amount or number of something

three **slices of** beef



two **sheets of** paper



a **spoonful of** sugar



a **bunch of** keys



Language help

We can usually use **slice** when talking about pieces of bread, cakes and meat. We can use **bunch** to talk about flowers, grapes, bananas and keys.

Exercises

64.1 How do you pronounce the underlined letters? Use the index to help you.

- | | | | |
|----------------|--|--------------------|---|
| 1 <u>t</u> in | Is it like <u>f</u> ine or <u>w</u> ind? <i>wind</i> | 5 <u>c</u> ouple | Is it like <u>p</u> ool or <u>c</u> up? |
| 2 <u>p</u> air | Is it like <u>c</u> ar or <u>c</u> are? | 6 <u>d</u> ozen | Is it like <u>r</u> un or <u>r</u> ob? |
| 3 <u>v</u> ase | Is it like <u>f</u> ar or <u>f</u> ace? | 7 <u>q</u> uantity | Is it like <u>r</u> an or <u>w</u> ant? |
| 4 <u>t</u> ube | Is it like <u>n</u> oon or <u>n</u> ew? | | |

64.2 Complete the phrases below.



- | | |
|----------------------------|----------------------|
| 1 a <u>bottle</u> of water | 6 a _____ of water |
| 2 a _____ of spaghetti | 7 a _____ of matches |
| 3 a _____ of fruit | 8 a _____ of soap |
| 4 a _____ of coffee | 9 a _____ of apples |
| 5 a _____ of milk | |

64.3 Correct the mistake with the container.

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 1 a packet of chocolate <u>bar</u> | 5 a can of milk _____ |
| 2 a vase of jam _____ | 6 a carton of toothpaste _____ |
| 3 a tube of cigarettes _____ | 7 a jar of flowers _____ |
| 4 a tin of cola _____ | 8 a jug of biscuits _____ |

64.4 Complete the sentences with one word.

- I need two pairs of socks inside these shoes.
- I gave her a big _____ of flowers from my garden.
- I cut about six _____ of bread and put them on a plate.
- Could you get half a _____ more chairs?
- The teacher told us to take out a blank _____ of paper.
- I like to put a _____ of cream in my coffee.
- There's no need to hurry – we've got _____ of time.
- I met a _____ of friends – Stefan and Julia – on the way to the station.
- She opened her bag on the table, turned it upside down, and all the _____ fell out.
- Tennis is quite popular in our office. I know _____ people who play.

64.5 Cross out the wrong answer.

- Could you get a carton of *milk* / *juice* / *coffee*?
- I bought a bunch of *grapes* / *bananas* / *apples*.
- There were *a couple of* / *a pair of* / *several* people waiting at the bus stop.
- Would you like a slice of *cake* / *bread* / *biscuit*?
- It's nice with a spoonful of *sugar* / *jam* / *crisps*.
- I bought two pairs of *socks* / *shirts* / *jeans*.
- Have you got a *piece* / *bunch* / *sheet* of paper I could borrow?